

RACI is an acronym that comes from four classifications of involvement: Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed. The RACI matrix is one of many ways that companies organize roles and responsibilities. Although you may encounter other structural models, the RACI matrix offers you a lot of information on workplace responsibilities in a simple way. When companies employ the RACI matrix, stakeholders and cross-functional team members have a clearer understanding of involvement throughout the entire project. It is a model that helps to define roles and responsibilities for individuals or teams to ensure work gets done efficiently by listing who is "responsible," "accountable," "consulted," and "informed" for project tasks.

The matrix identifies and assigns project tasks to one of the following levels of engagement:

- **Responsible:** The cross-functional team members in this role are directly responsible for performing the work necessary or make decisions that are directly related to completing a task within a project. There can be several roles or groups responsible for the task, meaning that the responsibilities are held jointly by more than one classification.
- **Accountable:** Those assigned the accountable role within a task are given the job of approving the work performed by those who are "responsible." As a general rule there is usually a single person in this role, often a manager or a project lead.
- **Consulted:** This role applies to those assigned to offer input on a task. There should be a clear and open line of 2-way communication between those assigned to "responsible" and "consulted." There can be several people in this role. In many situations, they are referred to as subject matter experts, or SMEs for short.
- **Informed:** Those in this role need to be kept aware of progress and concerns of those working on a project. These responsibilities tend to be assigned to higher levels of senior leadership. They need to understand the insights from projects rather than the details of how specific tasks are performed.

By labeling someone to one of these four categories, the RACI matrix helps categorize their level of involvement and proximity to each task. When you know who is involved, and at what level, it's easier to determine who to contact if any concerns arise.

Step 1: Assign responsibility

Task	Business Intelligence Engineer	Data Scientist	Analytic Team Manager	Data Engineer
Access to data	R	C	R	R
Create models to analyze data	C	R	C	I
Drive insights and recommendations based on data	C	R	C	I

Step 2: Expand your RACI matrix

Task	Business Intelligence Engineer	Data Scientist	Analytic Team Manager	Data Engineer	Chief Data Officer
Access to data	R	C	R	R	A
Create Models to Analyze Data	C	R	C	I	A
Drive Insights & Recommendations Based on Data	C	R	C	I	A
Ensure Data Compliance	I	I	I	R	A

RACI matrix #1:

- **Access to data:** Based on their general roles within an organization, the business intelligence engineer, analytics team manager, and data engineer have all been identified as responsible for providing access to the data. The data scientist, who is more responsible for working with the analytics team to draw insights from the data, is just consulted.
- **Create models to analyze data:** The data scientist, who is primarily concerned with drawing insights from the data, is responsible for this task. The business intelligence engineer and analytics team manager are consulted. The data engineer, who is concerned with infrastructure, is kept informed.

- **Drive insights and recommendations based on data:** Similarly to the previous task, the data scientist is the primary team member responsible for this task.

RACI matrix #2:

- **Ensure data compliance:** Data compliance is part of developing and managing databases, which is the responsibility of the data engineer. Other team members are consulted or informed, but the data engineer is tasked with the actual responsibility of ensuring compliance.
- **Chief data officer:** Although all of the tasks in this project are the direct responsibility of other team members, the company's chief data officer is accountable for them—meaning this role has the ultimate responsibility for ensuring this task is completed.